

Notes on MATH 223

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Chapter 1. Complex Numbers

1. Structure of Complex Numbers

Definition 1.1.1 (Complex Numbers):

The set of **complex numbers**, denoted by $\mathbb{C}$, is the Cartesian product of the real numbers with itself. That is

$$\mathbb{C} := \mathbb{R} \times \mathbb{R}.$$

A typical element $z \in \mathbb{C}$ can be expressed as an ordered pair of real numbers (x, y) . The set of complex numbers as for now is just a set of ordered pairs. Thus, we shall define some operations on $\mathbb{C}$ to give it more structure.

Definition 1.1.2 (Operations Within Complex Numbers):

The **addition** of two complex numbers $z_1 = (x_1, y_1)$ and $z_2 = (x_2, y_2)$ is defined as

$$z_1 + z_2 := (x_1 + x_2, y_1 + y_2).$$

The **multiplication** of two complex numbers $z_1 = (x_1, y_1)$ and $z_2 = (x_2, y_2)$ is defined as

$$z_1 z_2 := (x_1 x_2 - y_1 y_2, x_1 y_2 + x_2 y_1).$$

Theorem 1.1.3 (Complex Field):

The set of complex numbers $\mathbb{C}$ with the operations of addition and multiplication defined in **Definition 1.1.2** are *well-defined* and *satisfy the properties that we expect them to have*.

Definition 1.1.4 (Imaginary Unit):

The **imaginary unit** i is defined as the complex number $(0, 1)$.

The imaginary unit i has a very interesting property, which is that

$$i^2 = (0, 1)(0, 1) = (-1, 0).$$

Corollary 1.1.5 (Decomposition of Complex):

A complex number $z = (x, y)$ can be written as $z = (x, 0) + i(y, 0)$.

Proof 1.1.5:

Consider a complex number $z = (x, 0) + i(y, 0)$. We have

$$z = (x, 0) + (0, 1)(y, 0) = (x, 0) + (0, y) = (x, y).$$

■

Theorem 1.1.6 (Embedding of Real in Complex):

Let R be the set of all complex numbers of the form $(x, 0)$, where $x \in \mathbb{R}$. That is

$$R = \{(x, 0) : x \in \mathbb{R}\}.$$

Then, R is a subset of $\mathbb{C}$ and R is *structurally equivalent* to $\mathbb{R}$.

Proof 1.1.6:

As we need to properly define the word *equivalent* before we can prove the theorem, we shall only first do an informal demonstration of the theorem here.

To show that R is *structurally equivalent* to $\mathbb{R}$, let's first show that R is *itself equivalent* to $\mathbb{R}$. Consider an element $(x, 0) \in R$, we can associate it to a **unique** element $x \in \mathbb{R}$ and **vice versa**. This is called a **bijection**, which somewhat means that R and $\mathbb{R}$ have the same number of elements.

Furthermore, we claim that the **addition** and **multiplication** of two elements in R are *equivalent* to the addition and multiplication of the corresponding elements in $\mathbb{R}$. To show this, consider two elements $(x_1, 0), (x_2, 0) \in R$, we have

$$(x_1, 0) + (x_2, 0) = (x_1 + x_2, 0),$$

which corresponds to the sum of x_1 and x_2 in $\mathbb{R}$. Similarly, we have

$$(x_1, 0)(x_2, 0) = (x_1 x_2, 0),$$

which also corresponds to the product of x_1 and x_2 in $\mathbb{R}$.

Since the **addition** and **multiplication** on these two sets are *equivalent*, any other operations derived from these two operations (such as subtraction, division, exponential) are also *equivalent*. Hence, we can conclude that R and $\mathbb{R}$ are *structurally equivalent*.

Convention 1.1.7:

Now, due to this *structural equivalence*, we will denote any complex number of the form $(x, 0)$ directly by x and **call** this number a **real number**.

Moreover, we will borrow any function $f : \mathbb{R} \mapsto \mathbb{R}$ to R , by defining a function $f_R : R \mapsto R$ as

$$f_R((x, 0)) := (f(x), 0).$$

Corollary 1.1.8 (Alternative Notation):

A complex number $z = (x, y)$ can be written as

$$z = (x, y) = (x, 0) + i(y, 0) = x + iy.$$

For a complex number $z = x + iy$, we call x the **real part** of z and denote it by $\Re(z)$ or $\text{Re}(z)$, and we call y the **imaginary part** of z and denote it by $\Im(z)$ or $\text{Im}(z)$.

Definition 1.1.9 (Complex Conjugate):

The **complex conjugate** of a complex number $z = x + iy$ is defined as

$$\bar{z} := x - iy.$$

One can immediately verify that the complex conjugate has the following property:

$$z\bar{z} = (x + iy)(x - iy) = x^2 + y^2.$$

Due to **Convention 1.1.7**, we treat $x^2 + y^2$ as real number. Since $z\bar{z} = x^2 + y^2$ is a **non-negative real number**, we can take the square root of it.

Definition 1.1.10 (Modulus):

The **modulus** of a complex number $z = x + iy$ is defined as

$$|z| := \sqrt{z\bar{z}} = \sqrt{x^2 + y^2}.$$

Corollary 1.1.11 (Modulus and Conjugate):

The modulus of a complex number z is always a non-negative real number, that is,

$$|z| \geq 0.$$

Corollary 1.1.12 (Inverse of a Complex Number):

A complex number $z = x + iy \neq 0$ has a multiplicative inverse, which is given by

$$\frac{1}{z} = \frac{1}{z} \frac{\bar{z}}{\bar{z}} = \frac{\bar{z}}{|z|^2} = \frac{x}{|z|^2} - i \frac{y}{|z|^2}$$

2. Polynomials and Complex Roots

Theorem 1.2.1 (Fundamental Theorem of Algebra):

Every non-constant polynomial with complex coefficients has at least one complex root.

Theorem 1.2.2 (Factorization of Polynomials):

If f is a degree n polynomial with complex coefficients, then f can be factored into n **linear factors**.

$$f = a(X - z_1)(X - z_2)\dots(X - z_n),$$

where $z_1, z_2, \dots, z_n$ are the complex roots of f and a is the leading coefficient of f .

3. Geometric Interpretation of Complex Numbers

Lemma 1.3.1 (Euler's Formula):

Let $\theta \in \mathbb{R}$. Then, we have

$$e^{i\theta} = \cos(\theta) + i \sin(\theta).$$

Corollary 1.3.2 (Modulus of Exponential):

One can immediately verify that the modulus of $e^{i\theta}$ is always 1, that is,

$$|e^{i\theta}| = \sqrt{\cos^2(\theta) + \sin^2(\theta)} = 1.$$

Corollary 1.3.3 (Polar Form):

One can also verify that any complex number z can be written in the form

$$z = re^{i\theta},$$

where $r = |z| \in \mathbb{R}$ and $\arg(z) := \theta$ is called the **argument** of z .

4. Properties of Complex Numbers

Definition 1.4.1 (Purely Imaginary Numbers):

A complex number z is called a **purely imaginary number** if its real part is zero, that is,

$$\Re(z) = 0.$$

Corollary 1.4.2 (Re and Im Function):

The real part and the imaginary part of a complex number z can be expressed in terms of z and its complex conjugate as follows:

$$\Re(z) = \frac{z + \bar{z}}{2} \text{ and } \Im(z) = \frac{z - \bar{z}}{2i}.$$

Corollary 1.4.3 (Conjugate, Real, Purely Imaginary):

If a complex number z has the following property:

$$z = -\bar{z},$$

then it is a purely imaginary number.

If a complex number z has the following property:

$$z = \bar{z},$$

then it is a real number.

Chapter 2. Algebraic Structures

1. Groups, Rings, and Fields

Definition 2.1.1 (Groups):

A **group** is a set G together with a binary operation $\cdot$ that satisfies the following properties:

1. **Closure:** For all $a, b \in G$, we have $a \cdot b \in G$.
2. **Associativity:** For all $a, b, c \in G$, we have $(a \cdot b) \cdot c = a \cdot (b \cdot c)$.
3. **Identity:** There exists an element $e \in G$ such that for all $a \in G$, we have $e \cdot a = a \cdot e = a$.
4. **Inverse:** For each element $a \in G$, there exists an element $b \in G$ such that $a \cdot b = b \cdot a = e$.

Definition 2.1.2 (Monoids and Semigroups):

A **monoid** is a set S together with a binary operation $\cdot$ that satisfies the following properties:

1. **Closure**
2. **Associativity**
3. **Identity**

A **semigroup** is a set S together with a binary operation $\cdot$ that satisfies the following properties:

1. **Closure**
2. **Associativity**

Corollary 2.1.3 (Uniqueness of Identity and Inverse):

The **identity element** and the **inverse of each element** in a group are unique.

Proof 2.1.3:

Let G be a group and let e and e' be two identity elements in G . Then, we have

$$e = e \cdot e' = e'.$$

Hence, the identity element is unique.

Let $a \in G$ and let b and b' be two inverses of a . Then, we have

$$b = b \cdot e = b \cdot (a \cdot b') = (b \cdot a) \cdot b' = e \cdot b' = b'.$$

Hence, the inverse of each element is unique.

■

Definition 2.1.4 (Abelian Groups):

A group G is called an **Abelian group** if the binary operation $\cdot$ is **commutative**, that is, for all $a, b \in G$, we have $a \cdot b = b \cdot a$.

Definition 2.1.5 (Rings):

A **ring** is a set R together with two binary operations $+$, called **addition**, and $\cdot$, called **multiplication**, such that:

1. $(R, +)$ is an **Abelian group**.
2. $(R, \cdot)$ is a **monoid**.
3. **Distributive Laws:** For all $a, b, c \in R$, we have
 - $a \cdot (b + c) = a \cdot b + a \cdot c$
 - $(a + b) \cdot c = a \cdot c + b \cdot c$

Definition 2.1.6 (Commutative Rings):

A **commutative ring** is a ring $R(+, \cdot)$ such that the **multiplication is commutative**, that is, for all $a, b \in R$, we have $a \cdot b = b \cdot a$.

Definition 2.1.7 (Fields):

A **field** is a set F together with two binary operations $+$ and $\cdot$, with its **additive identity** denoted by 0 , such that:

1. $F(+, \cdot)$ is a **commutative ring**.
2. Every element $f \in F$ such that $f \neq 0$ has a **multiplicative inverse** in F .

Theorem 2.1.8 (Real Field):

The set of real numbers $\mathbb{R}$ with the usual addition and multiplication forms a **field**.

Proof 2.1.8:

Let's start by showing that $\mathbb{R}(+)$ is an Abelian group.

1. **Closure:** For all $a, b \in \mathbb{R}$, we have $a + b \in \mathbb{R}$.
2. **Associativity:** For all $a, b, c \in \mathbb{R}$, we have $(a + b) + c = a + (b + c)$.
3. **Identity:** The additive identity is 0 , since for all $a \in \mathbb{R}$, we have $0 + a = a + 0 = a$.
4. **Inverse:** For each element $a \in \mathbb{R}$, the additive inverse is $-a$, since we have $a + (-a) = (-a) + a = 0$.
5. **Commutativity:** For all $a, b \in \mathbb{R}$, we have $a + b = b + a$.

Now, let's show that $\mathbb{R}(\cdot)$ is a monoid.

1. **Closure:** For all $a, b \in \mathbb{R}$, we have $a \cdot b \in \mathbb{R}$.
2. **Associativity:** For all $a, b, c \in \mathbb{R}$, we have $(a \cdot b) \cdot c = a \cdot (b \cdot c)$.
3. **Identity:** The multiplicative identity is 1 , since for all $a \in \mathbb{R}$, we have $1 \cdot a = a \cdot 1 = a$.

Due to the **distributive laws** of real numbers, we can conclude that $\mathbb{R}$ is a **ring**. Moreover, it is a **commutative ring** since the multiplication of real numbers is commutative. Finally, **every non-zero real number has a multiplicative inverse**, which is also a real number. Hence, we can conclude that $\mathbb{R}$ is a **field**. ■

Theorem 2.1.9 (Complex Field):

Now, we can formally restate **Theorem 1.1.3** as follows: The set of complex numbers $\mathbb{C}$ with the operations of addition and multiplication defined in **Definition 1.1.2** forms a **field**.

The proof of this theorem follows the same idea as the proof for **Theorem 2.1.8**.

2. Isomorphisms

Two sets composed of very different mathematical objects might be *structurally similar* to each other to a point that an theorem proven in one can be directly applied to the other. Identifying this *similarity* is particularly useful, as it allows us to freely switch different perspectives and apply the tools we have in one to another. This is the motivation behind the concept of **isomorphism**.

Definition 2.2.1 (Isomorphisms):

An **isomorphism** is a **structure-preserving bijection** between two **structures**. If such an isomorphism exists between two structures, we say that these two structures are **isomorphic** to each other.

Definition 2.2.2 (Isomorphism between Algebraic Structures):

Let A and B be two algebraic structures of the same type (for example, two groups, or two rings).

An **isomorphism** between A and B is a bijection $f : A \mapsto B$ such that for all elements $a_1, a_2 \in A$ and for all binary operation $\cdot_A$ defined on A , we have

$$f(a_1 \cdot_A a_2) = f(a_1) \cdot_B f(a_2),$$

where $\cdot_B$ is the corresponding binary operation defined on B .

Theorem 2.2.3 (Isomorphism between $\mathbb{R}$ and R):

Now we can formally define the meaning of *structural equivalence* in **Theorem 1.1.6** as follows: The **field** of real numbers $\mathbb{R}$ is isomorphic to the **field** form by complex numbers of the form $(x, 0)$, where $x \in \mathbb{R}$.

Proof 2.2.3:

The proof is surprisingly simple and is already outlined in **Proof 1.1.6**. One only needs to formally reformulate the proof in **Proof 1.1.6** using the definition of isomorphism between algebraic structures.

Hence, we can conclude that $\mathbb{R}$ and R are isomorphic to each other.

Chapter 3. Vector Spaces

1. Structure of Vector Spaces

Definition 3.1.1 (Vector Spaces):

A **vector space** over a field F is a set V together with two operations, called **vector addition** and **scalar multiplication**, such that:

1. V and $+$, the **vector addition**, together form an **Abelian group**, with the **additive identity** denoted by 0.
2. The **scalar multiplication** is a function $F \times V \mapsto V$ that takes a scalar $a \in F$ and a vector $v \in V$ and produces a new vector $av \in V$ that satisfies the following properties:
 - **Closure:** For all $a \in F$ and $v \in V$, we have $av \in V$.
 - **Associativity:** For all $a, b \in F$ and $v \in V$, we have $(ab)v = a(bv)$.
 - **Identity:** For all $v \in V$, we have $1v = v$, where 1 is the **multiplicative identity** in F .
 - **Distributive Laws:** For all $a, b \in F$ and $u, v \in V$, we have
 1. $a(u + v) = au + av$
 2. $(a + b)v = av + bv$

Definition 3.1.2 (Linear Combination):

A **linear combination** of a set of vectors $S \subseteq V$ is a vector that can be expressed as a **finite sum** of scalar multiples of vectors in S . That is, a vector $v \in V$ is a linear combination of S if there exist scalars $\lambda^1, \dots, \lambda^n \in F$ and vectors $s_1, \dots, s_n \in S$ such that

$$v = \sum_{i=1}^n \lambda^i s_i.$$

Definition 3.1.3 (Span):

The **span** of a set of vectors $S \subseteq V$ is the set of all linear combinations of S . That is, the span of S is defined as

$$\text{span}_F(S) := \left\{ \sum_{i=1}^n \lambda^i s_i : n \in \mathbb{N}, \lambda^1, \dots, \lambda^n \in F, s_1, \dots, s_n \in S \right\}.$$

Corollary 3.1.4:

The span of a set of vectors S always contains the zero vector.

Definition 3.1.5 (Linear Independence):

A set of vectors $S \subseteq V$ is said to be **linear independent** if the only linear combination of S that equals the zero vector is the **trivial linear combination**, that is, the linear combination where all scalars are zero. Formally, S is linear independent if for any scalars $\lambda^1, \dots, \lambda^n \in F$ and vectors $s_1, \dots, s_n \in S$, we have

$$\sum_{i=1}^n \lambda^i s_i = 0 \Leftrightarrow \lambda^1 = \lambda^2 = \dots = \lambda^n = 0.$$

Theorem 3.1.6 (Linear Dependent Vectors):

Let S be a set of vectors in a vector space V . Let W be the **largest subset** of S that is linear independent. Then, every vector in S can be expressed as a linear combination of vectors in W .

Proof 3.1.6:

Let $W = \{w_1, w_2, \dots, w_n\}$, let $s \in S$ be an arbitrary vector in S that is not in W . Since W is the largest subset of S that is linear independent, we have that $W \cup \{s\}$ is linear dependent. Hence, there exist scalars $\lambda^1, \dots, \lambda^n, \lambda^{n+1} \in F$ such that

$$\sum_{i=1}^n \lambda^i w_i + \lambda^{n+1} s = 0.$$

If $\lambda^{n+1} = 0$, then the equation above reduces to

$$\sum_{i=1}^n \lambda^i w_i = 0,$$

since W is linear independent, we have $\lambda^1 = \lambda^2 = \dots = \lambda^n = 0$, which contradicts the assumption that $W \cup \{s\}$ is linear dependent. Hence, we have $\lambda^{n+1} \neq 0$. This means that we can rearrange the equation above to express s as a linear combination of vectors in W , that is,

$$s = - \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{\lambda^i}{\lambda^{n+1}} w_i.$$

■

Definition 3.1.7 (Basis):

A **basis** of a vector space V is an **set** of vectors $B \subseteq V$ that is both **linearly independent** and **spans** V . That is, B is a basis of V if

1. B is linear independent.
2. $\text{span}(B) = V$.

Definition 3.1.8 (Subspace):

A **subspace** of a vector space V is a subset $W \subseteq V$ that is itself a vector space with the same field under the same operations of vector addition and scalar multiplication defined on V .

Theorem 3.1.9 (Subspace Test):

A subset $W \subseteq V$ is a subspace of a vector space V if and only if for all $u, v \in W$ and $a \in F$, we have

$$au + v \in W.$$

Proof 3.1.9:

Let's first show that $(W, +)$ is an Abelian group.

1. **Closure:** Let $a = 1$, this means that for all $u, v \in W$, $u + v \in W$. This implies that W is closed under vector addition.
2. **Associativity:** Since $W \subseteq V$ and $(V, +)$ is an Abelian group, we have for all $u, v, w \in W$, $(u + v) + w = u + (v + w)$.

3. **Identity:** Let $a = -1$ and $u \in W$. Since $-1u + u = 0 \in W$, W contains the additive identity.
4. **Inverse:** Let $a = -1$ and $v = 0$. Since $-1u + 0 = -u \in W$, W contains the additive inverse of each of its elements.
5. **Commutativity:** Since $W \subseteq V$ and $(V, +)$ is an Abelian group, we have for all $u, v \in W$, $u + v = v + u$.

Then, let's show that the scalar multiplication on W satisfies the properties of scalar multiplication on a vector space.

1. **Closure:** Let $v = 0$, then for all $a \in F$ and $u \in W$, we have $au + 0 = au \in W$. This implies that W is closed under scalar multiplication.
2. **Associativity, Identity, and Distributive Laws:** Since $W \subseteq V$ and the scalar multiplication on V satisfies these properties, we have for all $a, b \in F$ and $u, v \in W$, $(ab)u = a(bu)$, $1u = u$, $a(u + v) = au + av$, and $(a + b)v = av + bv$.

This shows that if for all $u, v \in W$ and $a \in F$, we have $au + v \in W$, then W is a subspace of V .

Now, let's show the converse. If W is a subspace of V , then W is closed under vector addition and scalar multiplication. Hence, for all $u, v \in W$ and $a \in F$, we have $au + v \in W$.

■

Theorem 3.1.10 (Intersection of Subspaces):

The intersection of any collection of subspaces of a vector space V is also a subspace of V .

Proof 3.1.10:

Let S be a collection of subspaces of V and let $W = \bigcap_{U \in S} U$. We need to show that W is a subspace of V .

Let $u, v \in W$ and $a \in F$. Since $u, v \in W$, we have for all $U \in S$, $u, v \in U$.

Since each U is a subspace of V , we have for all $U \in S$, $au + v \in U$. Hence, we have for all $U \in S$, $au + v \in U$, which implies that $au + v \in W$. This shows that W is a subspace of V .

■

Theorem 3.1.11 (Span is a Subspace):

Let W be a subset of a vector space V . Then, the span of W is a subspace of V .

Proof 3.1.11:

Let $u, v \in \text{span}(W)$ and $a \in F$. Since $u, v \in \text{span}(W)$, we have that there exist scalars $\lambda^1, \dots, \lambda^n \in F$ and vectors $s_1, \dots, s_n \in W$ such that

$$u = \sum_{i=1}^n \lambda^i s_i.$$

Similarly, there exist scalars $\mu^1, \dots, \mu^m \in F$ and vectors $t_1, \dots, t_m \in W$ such that

$$v = \sum_{j=1}^m \mu^j t_j.$$

Hence, we have

$$au + v = a \sum_{i=1}^n \lambda^i s_i + \sum_{j=1}^m \mu^j t_j = \sum_{i=1}^n (a\lambda^i) s_i + \sum_{j=1}^m \mu^j t_j,$$

which is a linear combination of vectors in W . This shows that $au + v \in \text{span}(W)$, which implies that $\text{span}(W)$ is a subspace of V . ■

Theorem 3.1.12 (Span of a Subspace):

The span of a subspace W of a vector space V is equal to W itself, that is, $\text{span}(W) = W$.

Proof 3.1.12:

Since W is a subspace of V , it is closed under linear combinations. Hence, we have $\text{span}(W) \subseteq W$. On the other hand, since $W \subseteq W$, we have $W \subseteq \text{span}(W)$. This shows that $\text{span}(W) = W$. ■

Theorem 3.1.13 (Span of Subsets):

Let W be a subset of a vector space V . Then, the span of W is the smallest subspace of V that contains W . In other words, let S be the collection of all subspaces of V that contain W , then

$$\text{span}(W) = \bigcap_{U \in S} U.$$

Proof 3.1.13:

Let's start by first showing that for any $U \in S$,

$$\text{span}(W) \subseteq U.$$

Since $W \subseteq U$, we have that any linear combination of vectors in W is also a linear combination of vectors in U . Hence, we have $\text{span}(W) \subseteq \text{span}(U)$, but since U is a subspace of V , we have $\text{span}(U) = U$. This shows that $\text{span}(W) \subseteq U$ for any $U \in S$. Therefore,

$$\text{span}(W) \subseteq \bigcap_{U \in S} U.$$

However, since $\text{span}(W)$ is a subspace of V that contains W , we have $\text{span}(W) \in S$. Hence, we have

$$\bigcap_{U \in S} U \subseteq \text{span}(W).$$

Thus, this shows that $\text{span}(W) = \bigcap_{U \in S} U$.

Definition 3.1.14 (Linear Transformations):

Let V and W be vector spaces over a field F . A function $T : V \mapsto W$ is called a **linear transformation** if for all $u, v \in V$ and $a \in F$, we have

$$T(au + v) = aT(u) + T(v).$$

Definition 3.1.15 (Isomorphism between Vector Spaces):

Let V and W be two vector spaces over the same field F . An **isomorphism** between V and W is a **bijective linear transformation** $T : V \mapsto W$. If such an isomorphism exists, we say that V and W are **isomorphic** to each other.

Corollary 3.1.16 (Isomorphism Preserves Linear Independence):

Let V and W be two vector spaces over the same field F . If there is an isomorphism $T : V \mapsto W$ between V and W , then for any set of vectors $S \subseteq V$, we have that S is linear independent if and only if $T(S) := \{T(s) : s \in S\}$ is linear independent.

Theorem 3.1.17 (Condition of Being Injective):

Let V and W be two vector spaces over the same field F . A linear transformation $T : V \mapsto W$ is injective if and only if **it only maps the zero vector in V to the zero vector in W** , that is, $T(v) = 0 \Leftrightarrow v = 0$.

Proof 3.1.17:

Let T be an injective linear transformation between V and W , if there is a $c \neq 0$ such that $T(c) = 0$. Then, for any $v \in V$, we have

$$T(v + c) = T(v) + T(c) = T(v) + 0 = T(v).$$

This means that T is not injective, which contradicts the assumption. Hence, if T is injective, we have $T(v) = 0 \Leftrightarrow v = 0$.

On the other hand, if T is a linear transformation such that $T(v) = 0 \Leftrightarrow v = 0$, if there is a pair of vector v and w such that $T(v) = T(w)$ but $v \neq w$. Then, we have

$$T(v - w) = T(v) - T(w) = 0.$$

However, since $T(v) = 0 \Leftrightarrow v = 0$, we have $v - w = 0$, which implies that $v = w$. This contradicts the assumption that $v \neq w$. Hence, T is injective. ■

Corollary 3.1.18 (Condition of Being Isomorphism):

Let V and W be two vector spaces over the same field F . A linear transformation $T : V \mapsto W$ is an isomorphism if and only if **it only maps the zero vector in V to the zero vector in W** and it is **surjective**. That is,

1. $T(v) = 0 \Leftrightarrow v = 0$.
2. For all $w \in W$, there exists a $v \in V$ such that $T(v) = w$.

Theorem 3.1.19 (The Kernel of a Linear Transformation):

Let T be a linear transformation between two vector spaces V and W over the same field F . The set of all vectors in V that are mapped to the zero vector in W by T , called **kernel** or **null space** of T , denoted by $\ker(T)$, is a subspace of V .

Proof 3.1.19:

Let $a \in F$ and $u, v \in \ker(T)$, we shall show that $au + v \in \ker(T)$. Since $u, v \in \ker(T)$, we have $T(u) = T(v) = 0$. Hence, we have

$$T(au + v) = aT(u) + T(v) = a0 + 0 = 0,$$

that is, $au + v \in \ker(T)$. This shows that $\ker(T)$ is a subspace of V . ■

Theorem 3.1.20 (The Image of a Linear Transformation):

Let T be a linear transformation between two vector spaces V and W over the same field F . The set of all vectors in W that are mapped to by some vector in V by T , called **image** or **range** of T , denoted by $\text{im}(T)$, is a subspace of W .

Proof 3.1.20:

Let $a \in F$ and $u, v \in \text{im}(T)$, we shall show that $au + v \in \text{im}(T)$. Since $u, v \in \text{im}(T)$, there exist vectors $x, y \in V$ such that $T(x) = u$ and $T(y) = v$. Hence, we have

$$T(ax + y) = aT(x) + T(y) = au + v,$$

that is, $au + v \in \text{im}(T)$. This shows that $\text{im}(T)$ is a subspace of W . ■

Theorem 3.1.21 (Linear Transformations between Isomorphic Vector Spaces):

Let U, V , and W be two vector spaces over the same field F . If there is an isomorphism $I : V \mapsto W$ between V and W , then for any linear transformation $T_V : V \mapsto U$, there is a unique linear transformation $T_W : W \mapsto U$ such that for all $v \in V$, we have

$$T_V(v) = T_W \circ I(v).$$

Proof 3.1.21:

Let's define $T_W : W \mapsto U$ as follows: for all $w \in W$, we have

$$T_W(w) := T_V \circ I^{-1}(w).$$

Hence, for all $v \in V$, we have

$$T_W \circ I(v) = T_V \circ I^{-1} \circ I(v) = T_V(v).$$

We will omit the proof that T_W is a linear transformation, which can be easily verified by directly applying the definition of linear transformation and the fact that I is an isomorphism. Finally, let's show that T_W is unique. Let T'_W be another linear transformation such that for all $v \in V$, we have

$$T_V(v) = T'_W \circ I(v).$$

Since for all $v \in V$, there is a unique $w \in W$ such that $I(v) = w$, we have

$$T_V(v) = T_V \circ I^{-1}(w) = T_W \circ I \circ I^{-1}(w) = T'_W(w) = T_W(w).$$

Hence, this shows that T_W is unique. ■

2. Cartesian Space

Definition 3.2.1 (n-tuples):

An **n-tuple** is an ordered list of n elements, where n is a positive integer. An n-tuple, x can be denoted by

$$x = \begin{pmatrix} x^1 \\ \vdots \\ x^n \end{pmatrix},$$

where $x^1, x^2, \dots, x^n$ are the elements of the n-tuple.

Definition 3.2.2 (Cartesian Spaces: n-tuples Vector Spaces):

Let F be a field and let n be a positive integer. The set of all n-tuples of elements in F , denoted by F^n , forms a vector space over F with **addition** and **scalar multiplication** defined as follows:

1. Addition:

Let $x = \begin{pmatrix} x^1 \\ \vdots \\ x^n \end{pmatrix}$ and $y = \begin{pmatrix} y^1 \\ \vdots \\ y^n \end{pmatrix}$ be two n-tuples in F^n . Then, the sum of x and y is defined as

$$x + y = \begin{pmatrix} x^1 \\ \vdots \\ x^n \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} y^1 \\ \vdots \\ y^n \end{pmatrix} := \begin{pmatrix} x^1 + y^1 \\ \vdots \\ x^n + y^n \end{pmatrix}.$$

2. Scalar Multiplication:

Let $x = \begin{pmatrix} x^1 \\ \vdots \\ x^n \end{pmatrix}$ be an n-tuple in F^n and let $\lambda \in F$ be a scalar. Then, the scalar multiplication of a and x is defined as

$$\lambda x = \lambda \begin{pmatrix} x^1 \\ \vdots \\ x^n \end{pmatrix} := \begin{pmatrix} \lambda x^1 \\ \vdots \\ \lambda x^n \end{pmatrix}.$$

The zero vector in F^n is the n-tuple where all components are zero, that is, $\begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$.

Proof 3.2.2:

Since we are defining the addition and scalar multiplication component-wise, we can verify that the vector space axioms are satisfied by directly applying the corresponding properties of the field F to each component of the n-tuples. Hence, we can conclude that F^n is a vector space over F . ■

Theorem 3.2.3 (Standard Basis):

Let F^n be a vector space of n-tuples over a field F . Then, the **ordered list** of n-tuples

$$\mathfrak{B} = \left\{ e_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, e_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \dots, e_n = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \right\}$$

is a basis of F^n , which is called the **standard basis** of F^n .

Proof 3.2.3:

Let's first show that $\mathfrak{B}$ is linear independent. Consider a linear combination of $\mathfrak{B}$ that equals the zero vector, that is,

$$\sum_{i=1}^n \lambda^i e_i = 0.$$

But

$$\sum_{i=1}^n \lambda^i e_i = \begin{pmatrix} \lambda^1 \\ \lambda^2 \\ \vdots \\ \lambda^n \end{pmatrix}.$$

Hence, the only way for this linear combination to equal the zero vector is that $\lambda^1 = \lambda^2 = \dots = \lambda^n = 0$. This shows that $\mathfrak{B}$ is linear independent.

Now, let's show that $\mathfrak{B}$ spans F^n . Consider an arbitrary n-tuple $x = \begin{pmatrix} x^1 \\ \vdots \\ x^n \end{pmatrix} \in F^n$. We can write x as a linear combination of the vectors in $\mathfrak{B}$ as follows:

$$x = \sum_{i=1}^n x^i e_i.$$

That is $F^n \subseteq \text{span}(\mathfrak{B})$. On the other hand, since F^n is a vector space, it is closed under linear combinations. Hence, we have $\text{span}(\mathfrak{B}) \subseteq F^n$. This shows that $\text{span}(\mathfrak{B}) = F^n$. ■

Corollary 3.2.4 (Decomposition of Linear Transformations):

Let V and W be two Cartesian spaces over the same field F , that is, $V = F^m$ and $W = F^n$ for some positive integers m and n , with standard basis $\{v_1, \dots, v_m\}$ and $\{w_1, \dots, w_n\}$ respectively. Consider a linear transformation $T : V \mapsto W$, we have

$$T(v) = T\left(\sum_{i=1}^m v^i v_i\right) = \sum_{i=1}^m v^i T(v_i),$$

where $v^i \in F$ is the i -th components of v with respect to the standard basis of V . Now, since $T(v_i)$ is a vector in W , we can write it as a linear combination of the standard basis of W as follows:

$$T(v_i) = \sum_{j=1}^n T_i^j w_j,$$

where $T_i^j \in F$ is the j -th component of $T(v_i)$ with respect to the standard basis of W . Hence, we have

$$T(v) = \sum_{i=1}^m v^i \left(\sum_{j=1}^n T_i^j w_j \right) = \sum_{j=1}^n \sum_{i=1}^m T_i^j v^i w_j.$$

This means that **any linear transformation** between Cartesian spaces **can define and be defined by a set of scalars** $T_i^j \in F$ for $i = 1, \dots, m$ and $j = 1, \dots, n$.

Convention 3.2.5 (Matrix Representation of Linear Transformations):

In order to conveniently represent a linear transformation between Cartesian spaces, we can arrange the scalars T_i^j into a table like object called **matrix** as follows:

$$T = \begin{pmatrix} T_1^1 & T_2^1 & \dots & T_m^1 \\ T_1^2 & T_2^2 & \dots & T_m^2 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ T_1^n & T_2^n & \dots & T_m^n \end{pmatrix}$$

Applying the linear transformation T to a vector $v \in V$ is represented as follows:

$$T(v) = Tv = \begin{pmatrix} T_1^1 & T_2^1 & \dots & T_m^1 \\ T_1^2 & T_2^2 & \dots & T_m^2 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ T_1^n & T_2^n & \dots & T_m^n \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} v^1 \\ v^2 \\ \vdots \\ v^m \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \sum_{i=1}^m T_i^1 v^i \\ \sum_{i=1}^m T_i^2 v^i \\ \vdots \\ \sum_{i=1}^m T_i^n v^i \end{pmatrix} = \sum_{j=1}^n \sum_{i=1}^m T_i^j v^i w_j.$$

In particular, if the matrix T has n rows and m columns, we say that T is an **n by m matrix** or **$n \times m$ matrix**.

The operation of applying a linear transformation involves putting a matrix and a vector side by side and performing a series of multiplications and additions to produce a new vector. This operation is called **matrix multiplication**. We shall formally define this operation.

Definition 3.2.6 (Matrix Multiplication I):

Let $T : F^m \mapsto F^n$ be a linear transformation represented by the matrix

$$T = \begin{pmatrix} T_1^1 & T_2^1 & \dots & T_m^1 \\ T_1^2 & T_2^2 & \dots & T_m^2 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ T_1^n & T_2^n & \dots & T_m^n \end{pmatrix}$$

and let $v \in F^m$ be a vector represented by the n -tuple

$$v = \begin{pmatrix} v^1 \\ v^2 \\ \vdots \\ v^m \end{pmatrix}.$$

Then, the **matrix multiplication** of T and v is defined as

$$Tv := \begin{pmatrix} \sum_{i=1}^m T_i^1 v^i \\ \sum_{i=1}^m T_i^2 v^i \\ \vdots \\ \sum_{i=1}^m T_i^n v^i \end{pmatrix}.$$

Theorem 3.2.7 (Matrices and Linear Transformations):

Let $\mathcal{T}$ be the set of all linear transformations from F^m to F^n and let $M_{n \times m}(F)$ represents all linear transformations from F^m to F^n defined by n by m matrices with entries in F . Then, there is

$$\mathcal{T} = M_{n \times m}(F).$$

Proof 3.2.7:

Let $T : F^m \mapsto F^n$ be a linear transformation. Then, we can represent T by a matrix T as shown in **Corollary 3.2.4** and **Convention 3.2.5**. Hence, we have $T \in M_{n \times m}(F)$, which implies that $\mathcal{T} \subseteq M_{n \times m}(F)$.

Now, let T be an arbitrary n by m matrix with entries in F . Again, as shown in **Corollary 3.2.4** and **Convention 3.2.5** we can define a linear transformation $T : F^m \mapsto F^n$ by

$$T(v) = Tv$$

for all $v \in F^m$. This shows that for any matrix in $M_{n \times m}(F)$, there is a corresponding linear transformation in $\mathcal{T}$. Hence, we have $M_{n \times m}(F) \subseteq \mathcal{T}$.

Therefore, we can conclude that $\mathcal{T} = M_{n \times m}(F)$. ■

Theorem 3.2.8 (Matrices are Vectors):

Let $M_{n \times m}(F)$ be the set of all n by m matrices with entries in a field F . Then, $M_{n \times m}(F)$ is a vector space over F with **addition** and **scalar multiplication** defined as follows:

$$A + B = \begin{pmatrix} A_1^1 & A_2^1 & \cdots & A_m^1 \\ A_1^2 & A_2^2 & \cdots & A_m^2 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ A_1^n & A_2^n & \cdots & A_m^n \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} B_1^1 & B_2^1 & \cdots & B_m^1 \\ B_1^2 & B_2^2 & \cdots & B_m^2 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ B_1^n & B_2^n & \cdots & B_m^n \end{pmatrix} := \begin{pmatrix} A_1^1 + B_1^1 & A_2^1 + B_2^1 & \cdots & A_m^1 + B_m^1 \\ A_1^2 + B_1^2 & A_2^2 + B_2^2 & \cdots & A_m^2 + B_m^2 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ A_1^n + B_1^n & A_2^n + B_2^n & \cdots & A_m^n + B_m^n \end{pmatrix},$$

$$aA = a \begin{pmatrix} A_1^1 & A_2^1 & \cdots & A_m^1 \\ A_1^2 & A_2^2 & \cdots & A_m^2 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ A_1^n & A_2^n & \cdots & A_m^n \end{pmatrix} := \begin{pmatrix} aA_1^1 & aA_2^1 & \cdots & aA_m^1 \\ aA_1^2 & aA_2^2 & \cdots & aA_m^2 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ aA_1^n & aA_2^n & \cdots & aA_m^n \end{pmatrix}.$$

Proof 3.2.8:

It is straightforward to verify that the vector space axioms are satisfied by directly applying the corresponding properties of the field F to each component of the matrices. Hence, we can conclude that $M_{n \times m}(F)$ is a vector space over F . ■

In some cases, we need to perform multiple linear transformations in a sequence. For example, let $T : F^m \mapsto F^n$ and $S : F^n \mapsto F^p$ be two linear transformations, we might want to apply T to a vector $v \in F^m$ first and then apply S to the result, that is,

$$S(T(v)) = S \left(\begin{pmatrix} \sum_{i=1}^m T_i^1 v^i \\ \sum_{i=1}^m T_i^2 v^i \\ \vdots \\ \sum_{i=1}^m T_i^n v^i \end{pmatrix} \right) = \begin{pmatrix} \sum_{j=1}^n \sum_{i=1}^m S_j^1 T_i^j v^i \\ \sum_{j=1}^n \sum_{i=1}^m S_j^2 T_i^j v^i \\ \vdots \\ \sum_{j=1}^n \sum_{i=1}^m S_j^p T_i^j v^i \end{pmatrix}$$

Notice how we can first compute the sum for the index j , that is

$$S(T(v)) = \begin{pmatrix} \sum_{i=1}^m \left(\sum_{j=1}^n S_j^1 T_i^j \right) v^i \\ \sum_{i=1}^m \left(\sum_{j=1}^n S_j^2 T_i^j \right) v^i \\ \vdots \\ \sum_{i=1}^m \left(\sum_{j=1}^n S_j^p T_i^j \right) v^i \end{pmatrix}.$$

Since the result of the sum for the index j is a scalar, $S(T(v))$ uniquely defines a linear transformation $R : F^m \mapsto F^p$ by the matrix $\mathbf{R}$:

$$\mathbf{R} = \begin{pmatrix} \sum_{j=1}^n S_j^1 T_1^j & \sum_{j=1}^n S_j^1 T_2^j & \cdots & \sum_{j=1}^n S_j^1 T_m^j \\ \sum_{j=1}^n S_j^2 T_1^j & \sum_{j=1}^n S_j^2 T_2^j & \cdots & \sum_{j=1}^n S_j^2 T_m^j \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \sum_{j=1}^n S_j^p T_1^j & \sum_{j=1}^n S_j^p T_2^j & \cdots & \sum_{j=1}^n S_j^p T_m^j \end{pmatrix}.$$

This is particularly convenient, as now we have

$$S(T(v)) = S(Tv) = \mathbf{R}v.$$

Hence, for simplicity, we will denote the matrix $\mathbf{R}$ as a **product** of the matrices $\mathbf{S}$ and $\mathbf{T}$ to mimic the associativity. That is,

$$\mathbf{R} = \mathbf{ST}.$$

In other words,

$$S(Tv) = (\mathbf{ST})v = \mathbf{R}v.$$

Definition 3.2.9 (Matrix Multiplication II):

Let $\mathbf{S}$ be an p by n matrix and let $\mathbf{T}$ be an n by m matrix. Then, the **matrix multiplication** of $\mathbf{S}$ and $\mathbf{T}$ is defined as the p by m matrix

$$\mathbf{ST} = \begin{pmatrix} S_1^1 & \cdots & S_n^1 \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ S_1^p & \cdots & S_n^p \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} T_1^1 & \cdots & T_m^1 \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ T_1^n & \cdots & T_m^n \end{pmatrix} := \begin{pmatrix} \sum_{j=1}^n S_j^1 T_1^j & \cdots & \sum_{j=1}^n S_j^1 T_m^j \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \sum_{j=1}^n S_j^p T_1^j & \cdots & \sum_{j=1}^n S_j^p T_m^j \end{pmatrix}.$$

Corollary 3.2.10 (Associativity of Matrix Multiplication):

Let R , S , and T be matrices such that the products RS and ST are defined. Then, we have

$$R(ST) = (RS)T.$$

Proof 3.2.10:

Applying $R(ST)$ on an arbitrary vector v , since $(ST)v = S(Tv)$ we have

$$R(ST)v = R(S(Tv)),$$

but Tv is just a vector, hence we have

$$R(S(Tv)) = (RS)(Tv) = (RS)Tv.$$

This shows that $R(ST) = (RS)T$. ■

Corollary 3.2.11 (Alternative Form of Representing Matrices):

Let T be an n by m matrix. We can also represent T as follows:

$$T = \begin{pmatrix} | & & | \\ T_1 & \cdots & T_m \\ | & & | \end{pmatrix},$$

where $T_1, \dots, T_m$ are the columns of T . On the other hand, we can also represent T as follows:

$$T = \begin{pmatrix} - & T^1 & - \\ & \vdots & \\ - & T^n & - \end{pmatrix},$$

where $T^1, \dots, T^n$ are the rows of T .

We can treat $T_1, \dots, T_m$ as vectors in F^n and $T^1, \dots, T^n$ as vectors in F^m or a $n \times 1$ and a $m \times 1$ matrix respectively depending on the context. If we treat them as matrices, then we can rewrite the matrix multiplication of S and T as follows:

$$ST = \begin{pmatrix} - & S^1 & - \\ & \vdots & \\ - & S^p & - \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} | & & | \\ T_1 & \cdots & T_m \\ | & & | \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} S^1 T_1 & \cdots & S^1 T_m \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ S^p T_1 & \cdots & S^p T_m \end{pmatrix},$$

where

$$S^i T_j = (S_1^i \cdots S_n^i) \begin{pmatrix} T_j^1 \\ \vdots \\ T_j^n \end{pmatrix} = \sum_{k=1}^n S_k^i T_j^k.$$

If we treat them as vectors, then we can rewrite the matrix multiplication of S and T as follows:

$$ST = S \begin{pmatrix} | & & | \\ T_1 & \cdots & T_m \\ | & & | \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} | & & | \\ S(T_1) & \cdots & S(T_m) \\ | & & | \end{pmatrix}.$$

Definition 3.2.12 (Identity Matrix):

The **identity matrix** of size n is the n by n matrix

$$I_n = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & \cdots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \cdots & 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Corollary 3.2.13 (Identity Matrix as a Linear Transformation):

The identity matrix I_n represents the identity linear transformation $\text{id} : F^n \mapsto F^n$ defined by $\text{id}(v) = v$ for all $v \in F^n$. Since

$$I_n v = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & \cdots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \cdots & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} v^1 \\ v^2 \\ \vdots \\ v^n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} v^1 \\ v^2 \\ \vdots \\ v^n \end{pmatrix} = v,$$

for all $v \in F^n$.

Definition 3.2.14 (Inverse of a Matrix):

Let A be a matrix. If there exists a matrix B such that

$$AB = BA = I.$$

then we say that B is the **inverse** of A and we denote it by A^{-1} .

Corollary 3.2.15 (The Shape of an Invertible Matrix):

If T is an invertible matrix, then T must be a square matrix, that is, the number of rows and the number of columns of T must be the same.

Proof 3.2.15:

Since for T to be invertible, there must exist a matrix T^{-1} such that

$$TT^{-1} = T^{-1}T = I,$$

the only way for this to hold is that T and T^{-1} are both square matrices of the same size. Hence, if T is an invertible matrix, then T must be a square matrix. ■

Corollary 3.2.16 (Invertible Matrix is an Isomorphism):

Let T be an invertible matrix. Then, the linear transformation, T , represented by T is an isomorphism.

Proof 3.2.16:

Let $T : F^n \mapsto F^n$ be the linear transformation represented by T . Since T is invertible, there exists a matrix T^{-1} such that

$$TT^{-1}v = T^{-1}Tv = Iv.$$

This shows that T is a bijective linear transformation, hence an isomorphism.

■

Theorem 3.2.17 (Columns of an Invertible Matrix Are Independent):

Let T be an invertible matrix. Then, the columns of T are linearly independent.

Proof 3.2.17:

Let T be an invertible matrix and let $T : F^m \mapsto F^n$ be the linear transformation represented by T . Since T is invertible, T is an isomorphism.

Let $T_1, \dots, T_n$ be the columns of T . If there exist scalars $\lambda^1, \dots, \lambda^n \in F$, not all zero, such that

$$\sum_{i=1}^n \lambda^i T_i = 0,$$

This means that

$$T \begin{pmatrix} \lambda^1 \\ \vdots \\ \lambda^n \end{pmatrix} = T \left(\begin{pmatrix} \lambda^1 \\ \vdots \\ \lambda^n \end{pmatrix} \right) = 0,$$

but this contradicts with the fact that T is an isomorphism, which only maps the zero vector to the zero vector as shown in **Corollary 3.1.18**. Hence, the columns of T are linearly independent.

■

3. Linear Equations

Definition 3.3.1 (Linear Equations):

A **linear equation** is an equation of the form

$$a_1x_1 + a_2x_2 + \cdots + a_nx_n = b,$$

where $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$ and b are constants and $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n$ are variables.

Corollary 3.3.2 (Matrix Form of Linear Equations):

A system of linear equations can be represented in matrix form as follows:

$$Ax = A \begin{pmatrix} x^1 \\ x^2 \\ \vdots \\ x^n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} b^1 \\ b^2 \\ \vdots \\ b^m \end{pmatrix} = b.$$

where A is an m by n matrix of coefficients, x is a vector of variables, and b is a vector of constants.

Definition 3.3.3 (Solution of Linear Equations):

A **solution** of a system of linear equations is a vector x that satisfies the equation $Ax = b$.

Theorem 3.3.4 (Existence of Solutions):

Let A be an m by n matrix and let b be a vector in F^m . Then, the system of linear equations $Ax = b$ has a solution if and only if the vector b is in the span of the columns of A .

Proof 3.3.4:

Let $A_1, A_2, \dots, A_n$ be the columns of A . Then, we can write

$$\begin{aligned} Ax &= \begin{pmatrix} A_1^1 & \cdots & A_n^1 \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ A_1^m & \cdots & A_n^m \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x^1 \\ \vdots \\ x^n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \sum_{i=1}^n A_i^1 x^i \\ \vdots \\ \sum_{i=1}^n A_i^m x^i \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^n x^i \begin{pmatrix} | \\ A_i \\ | \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^n x^i A_i. \end{aligned}$$

Therefore, the system of linear equations $Ax = b$ has a solution if and only if there exist scalars $x^1, \dots, x^n \in F$ such that

$$\sum_{i=1}^n x^i A_i = b,$$

that is, if and only if b is in the span of the columns of A .

■

Definition 3.3.5 (Column Space):

Let A be an m by n matrix. The **column space** of A , denoted by $\text{colspace}(A)$, is the span of the columns of A .

Definition 3.3.6 (Homogeneous Linear Equations):

A system of linear equations is called **homogeneous** if the vector of constants b is the zero vector, that is, if the system can be written in the form $Ax = 0$.

Corollary 3.3.7 (Trivial Solution of Homogeneous Linear Equations):

A homogeneous system of linear equations always has at least one solution, which is the zero vector. This solution is called the **trivial solution** of the homogeneous system.

Theorem 3.3.8 (Nontrivial Solutions of Homogeneous Linear Equations I):

Let A be an m by n matrix. Then, the homogeneous system of linear equations $Ax = 0$ has a nontrivial solution if and only if the columns of A are linearly dependent.

Proof 3.3.8:

Let $A_1, A_2, \dots, A_n$ be the columns of A . Then, as shown in **Proof 3.3.4** we can write

$$Ax = \sum_{i=1}^n x^i A_i.$$

Therefore, the homogeneous system of linear equations $Ax = 0$ has a nontrivial solution if and only if there exist scalars $x^1, \dots, x^n \in F$, not all zero, such that

$$\sum_{i=1}^n x^i A_i = 0,$$

that is, if and only if the columns of A are linearly dependent. ■

Theorem 3.3.9 (Nontrivial Solutions of Homogeneous Linear Equations II):

Let A be an m by n matrix. If the homogeneous system of linear equations $Ax = 0$ has a nontrivial solution, then it has infinitely many solutions (suppose that the field F has infinitely many scalars).

Proof 3.3.9:

Let x be a nontrivial solution of the homogeneous system of linear equations $Ax = 0$. Then, for any scalar $a \in F$, we have

$$A(ax) = a(Ax) = a0 = 0.$$

This shows that for any scalar $a \in F$, ax is also a solution of the homogeneous system of linear equations $Ax = 0$. Since there are infinitely many scalars in F , we have infinitely many solutions of the homogeneous system of linear equations $Ax = 0$. ■

4. Solving Linear Equations

A natural thought about solving a linear equation $Ax = b$ is to multiply both sides of the equation by the inverse of A , that is,

$$\begin{aligned} Ax &= b \\ A^{-1}Ax &= A^{-1}b \\ Ix &= A^{-1}b \\ x &= A^{-1}b. \end{aligned}$$

However, the reality is that **not all matrices** have inverses. For instance,

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

has no inverse, since for any matrix $B = \begin{pmatrix} B_1^1 & B_2^1 \\ B_1^2 & B_2^2 \end{pmatrix}$, we have

$$AB = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} B_1^1 & B_2^1 \\ B_1^2 & B_2^2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} B_1^1 & B_2^1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

It is also important to note that **the solutions of a system of linear equations might not be just numbers** (i.e. the solutions are not unique, as shown in **Theorem 3.3.9**). For example, consider

$$Ax = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x^1 \\ x^2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

The solution of this system of linear equations is the equation itself:

$$x^1 + 2x^2 = 3.$$

It could also be that **the solutions do not exist at all** (i.e. $b \notin \text{colspan}(A)$). For example, consider

$$Ax = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x^1 \\ x^2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Thus, before we actually tackle the problem of finding the solutions of a system of linear equations, we should first figure out what **a solution looks like**.

Consider a general system of linear equations $Ax = b$ where A is an m by n matrix and b is a vector in F^m . That is,

$$Ax = \begin{pmatrix} A_1^1 & \cdots & A_n^1 \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ A_1^m & \cdots & A_n^m \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x^1 \\ \vdots \\ x^n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} b^1 \\ \vdots \\ b^m \end{pmatrix}.$$

If one were to imagine the process of solving this system of linear equations, one would intuitively think of attributing an equation to each variable and remove all other variables from that equations. However, in general, **there will be some variables that cannot be attributed with an equation**, as we have shown with examples above.

Hence, let's split the variables into two groups: let the set I_c contains the indices of the variables that **cannot be attributed with an equation** and let the set I_r contains the indices of the rest of the variables.

What we should **consider** as a **solution** of the system of linear equations $Ax = b$ is a **m list of equations** of the following form:

$$x^i = d^i - \sum_{j \in I_c} c_j^i x^j \text{ or } 0 = 0$$

for $c_j^i, d^i \in F$ and $i \in I_r$.

For instance, consider the system of linear equations

$$Ax = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 3 & 5 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 4 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x^1 \\ x^2 \\ x^3 \\ x^4 \\ x^5 \\ x^6 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 6 \\ 7 \\ 0 \\ 8 \end{pmatrix}.$$

It should be clear that variable x^3 , x^4 , and x^5 are the variables that cannot be attributed with an equation, hence we have $I_c = \{3, 4, 5\}$ and $I_r = \{1, 2, 6\}$.

The solution of this system of linear equations is the following list of equations:

$$\begin{cases} x^1 = 6 - (3x^3 + 5x^4 + 0x^5) \\ x^2 = 7 - (4x^3 + 0x^4 + 0x^5) \\ 0 = 0 \\ x^6 = 8 - (0x^3 + 0x^4 + 0x^5) \end{cases}.$$

The reason that we consider this list of equations as the solution of the system of linear equations is that we can plug in any values for x^3 , x^4 , x^5 into the list of equations to get a solution of the system of linear equations. For example, if we let $x^3 = 1$, $x^4 = 2$, and $x^5 = 3$ then we have

$$x^1 = -7, \quad x^2 = 3, \quad x^3 = 1, \quad x^4 = 2, \quad x^5 = 3, \quad x^6 = 8.$$

which is a valid solution of the system of linear equations $Ax = b$. It is also for this reason that we call the variables in I_c **free variables**, as they can freely vary without affecting the validity of the solution.

We shall now translate the list of equations into a matrix form. For any particular $i \in I_r$,

$$x^i = d^i - \sum_{j \in I_c} c_j^i x^j$$

$$x^i + \sum_{j \in I_c} c_j^i x^j = d^i.$$

Let $k(i)$ be the index of the equation attributed to the variable x^i for $i \in I_r$. To group the equations together, we can consider the following vector:

$$\begin{pmatrix} \vdots \\ x^i + \sum_{j \in I_c} c_j^i x^j \\ \vdots \end{pmatrix} = \sum_{i \in I_r} \left(x^i + \sum_{j \in I_c} c_j^i x^j \right) e_{k(i)} = \sum_{i \in I_r} d^i e_{k(i)} = \begin{pmatrix} \vdots \\ d^i \\ \vdots \end{pmatrix},$$

where $e_{k(i)}$ is the $k(i)$ -th vector in the standard basis of F^m , since there are m equations in the list of equations. However, notice that

$$\begin{aligned}
\sum_{i \in I_r} \left(x^i + \sum_{j \in I_c} c_j^i x^j \right) e_{k(i)} &= \sum_{i \in I_r} x^i e_{k(i)} + \sum_{i \in I_r} \left(\sum_{j \in I_c} c_j^i x^j \right) e_{k(i)} \\
&= \sum_{i \in I_r} x^i e_{k(i)} + \sum_{j \in I_c} \left(\sum_{i \in I_r} c_j^i e_{k(i)} \right) x^j.
\end{aligned}$$

Let $v_j = \sum_{i \in I_r} c_j^i e_{k(i)}$ be vectors in $\text{span} \left(\{e_{k(i)}\}_{i \in I_r} \right)$ for $j \in I_c$. Then, we have

$$\sum_{i \in I_r} \left(x^i + \sum_{j \in I_c} c_j^i x^j \right) e_{k(i)} = \sum_{i \in I_r} x^i e_{k(i)} + \sum_{j \in I_c} x^j v_j.$$

Notice how this is similar how we represent multiplication of a matrix and a vector as **the linear combination of the columns of the matrix** (as shown in **Proof 3.3.4**). Let C be the matrix whose columns are the vectors $e_{k(i)}$ for i -th columns where $i \in I_r$ and v_j for j -th columns where $j \in I_c$. Then, we can represent the list of equations as

$$Cx = d,$$

where d is the vector whose i -th component is d^i for $i \in I_r$ and 0 for $i \in I_c$.

Definition 3.4.1 (The Shape of the Solution):

Let A be an m by n matrix and let b be a vector in F^m . Let I_r be a subset of $\{1, \dots, n\}$ such that the variables with indices in I_r can be attributed with equations and let I_c be the complement of I_r in $\{1, \dots, n\}$. Let $c_j^i, d^i \in F$ for $i \in I_r$ and $j \in I_c$. Then, the **solution** of the system of linear equations $Ax = b$ is represented by the matrix equation

$$Cx = d,$$

where C is the matrix whose columns are the vectors $e_{k(i)}$ for i -th columns where $i \in I_r$ and $v_j = \sum_{i \in I_r} c_j^i e_{k(i)}$ for j -th columns where $j \in I_c$, and d is the vector whose i -th component is d^i for $i \in I_r$ and 0 for $i \in I_c$.

In other words, solving a system of linear equations is equivalent to find a way to **transform** the equation $Ax = b$ into the equation $Cx = d$ where C has a particular shape (i.e. the columns of C are **either standard basis vectors or linear combinations of standard basis vectors appeared in the columns of C**). For instance, C can be:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 5 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 4 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 \end{pmatrix} \text{ or } \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 3 & 0 & 5 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 & 1 & 4 \end{pmatrix}.$$

One may notice that there are many C that satisfy the condition, and they all represent the same solution of the system of linear equations $Ax = b$. Hence, mathematicians defined a particular C called the **row reduced echelon form** of A to represent the solution of the system of linear equations $Ax = b$ in a particular way, the uniqueness of the row reduced echelon form of a matrix will not be shown here as it does not affect how we solve a system of linear equations.

Definition 3.4.2 (Row Reduced Echelon Form):

Let $Ax = b$ be a valid system of linear equations where A is an m by n matrix and b is a vector in F^m . Let C be a matrix in the form defined by **Definition 3.4.1** that represents the solution of the system of linear equations $Ax = b$. We say that C is a **row reduced echelon form** of A , denoted by $C = \text{RREF}(A)$, if the following condition is satisfied:

If the k -th column of C , C_k , is

- **a standard basis vector**, then it is the **next available** standard basis vector that has not appeared in the columns of C before C_k . That is, if

$$e_1, e_2, \dots, e_p$$

have already appeared in the columns of C before C_k , then C_k must be e_{p+1} .

- **not a standard basis vector**, then it is the linear combination of the basis vectors that **appeared** in the columns of C **before** C_k . That is, if

$$e_1, e_2, \dots, e_p$$

have already appeared in the columns of C before C_k , then C_k must be

$$C_k = \sum_{i=1}^p c_k^i e_i,$$

where $c_k^i \in F$ for $i \in I_r$ and $i < k$.

If we consider the previous example,

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 5 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 4 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 \end{pmatrix}$$

is in **row reduced echelon form**, while

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 3 & 0 & 5 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 & 1 & 4 \end{pmatrix}$$

is not in **row reduced echelon form** since the second column is not a standard basis vector and it is not the linear combination of the first column (the only column before it).

With that, we are left with the task of figuring out how to **transform** the equation $Ax = b$ into the equation $Cx = d$ where C is in row reduced echelon form.

Theorem 3.4.3 (Invertible Transformation Preserves the Solutions):

Let A be a matrix and b be a vector, if

$$Ax = b$$

is a valid system of linear equations, then

$$T Ax = T b$$

has the same solution as $Ax = b$ for any invertible matrix T .

Proof 3.4.3:

Let x be a solution of the system of linear equations $Ax = b$. Then, we have

$$TAx = Tb.$$

Conversely, let x be a solution of the system of linear equations $TAx = Tb$. Since T is invertible, we have

$$Ax = T^{-1}(TAx) = T^{-1}(Tb) = b.$$

This shows that x is also a solution of the system of linear equations $Ax = b$. ■

Definition 3.4.4 (Elementary Row Operations):

Let A be an m by n matrix. An **elementary row operation** on A is one of the following operations:

1. **Row swapping:** swap the positions of two rows of A .
2. **Row scaling:** multiply all entries of a row of A by a nonzero scalar.
3. **Row addition:** add a scalar multiple of one row of A to another row of A .

Theorem 3.4.5 (Row Operations are Linear Transformations):

The **elementary row operations** on an m by n matrix defined in **Definition 3.4.4** can be represented by **left multiplication** of the matrix by an **invertible** m by m matrix.

Proof 3.4.5:

Let A be an m by n matrix. We will show that each of the three types of elementary row operations can be represented by left multiplication of A by an invertible m by m matrix.

1. Row swapping:

If T swaps the i -th and j -th rows of A , we shall define T as follows:

Let $\{I^i\}_{i \in \{1, \dots, m\}}$ be the i -th row of the identity matrix I_m . T is a matrix whose k -th row is I^k , except that the i -th row is I^j and the j -th row is I^i . For instance, if $m = 4$, $i = 2$, and $j = 4$, then we have

$$T = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

The inverse of T is itself, since swapping the same two rows again will return the original matrix. Hence, we have $T^{-1} = T$.

2. Row Scaling:

If T scales the i -th row of A by a nonzero scalar a , we shall define T as follows:

Let $\{I^i\}_{i \in \{1, \dots, m\}}$ be the i -th row of the identity matrix I_m . T is a matrix whose k -th row is I^k , except that the i -th row is aI^i where a is the nonzero scalar used for scaling. For instance, if $m = 4$, $i = 2$, and $a = 3$, then we have

$$T = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 3 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

The inverse of T is the matrix whose k -th row is I^k , except that the i -th row is $(\frac{1}{a})I^i$. Hence, we have

$$T^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & \frac{1}{3} & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

3. Row addition:

If T adds a times the j -th row of A to the i -th row of A , we shall define T as follows:

Let $\{I^i\}_{i \in \{1, \dots, m\}}$ be the i -th row of the identity matrix I_m . T is a matrix whose k -th row is I^k , except that the i -th row is $I^i + aI^j$ where a is the scalar used for addition. For instance, if $m = 4$, $i = 2$, $j = 4$, and $a = 3$, then we have

$$T = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

The inverse of T is the matrix whose k -th row is I^k , except that the i -th row is $I^i - aI^j$. Hence, we have

$$T^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & -3 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Corollary 3.4.6 (Row Operations Preserve the Solution):

Let A be an m by n matrix and let b be a vector in F^m . If T is an invertible matrix that represents an elementary row operation on A , then the system of linear equations $TAx = Tb$ has the same solution as the system of linear equations $Ax = b$. This is shown in **Theorem 3.4.3**.

This means we can freely apply any elementary row operation on a system of linear equations in attempt to transform the system of linear equations into a system of linear equations with a **particular shape** (i.e. the **row reduced echelon form**) without worrying about changing the solution of the system of linear equations.

We shall now develop an **algorithm** to do so. Let A be an m by n matrix and let b be a vector in F^m , consider the system of linear equations $Ax = b$. We shall represent A as its columns:

$$Ax = \begin{pmatrix} | & & | \\ A_1 & \cdots & A_n \\ | & & | \end{pmatrix} x = b.$$

Let's consider A as an **ordered list of columns**. The idea is simple, since we want to transform A in row reduced echelon form, we will **process** the columns of A one by one from left to right. If the current column, A_k , is **not a linear combination of previous columns**, then we will use **elementary row operations** to transform the current column into the **next available standard basis vector**.

However, one may notice that to figure out whether A_k is a linear combination of previous columns, we need to **solve** the system of linear equations

$$A_k = \sum_{i=1}^{k-1} c_k^i A_i,$$

where c_k^i are scalars in F . This seems to be a **circular** problem since we are trying to solve a system of linear equations in order to solve a system of linear equations.

The remedy to this problem is actually obvious once one actually tries to process the columns of A one by one from left to right.

Let's say that we already found a list of row operations, $T = T_1 \cdots T_p$, that changes all the previous columns of A_k into the appropriate form. That is, some of the A_i for $i < k$ are transformed into standard basis vectors, let's say that $A_{i_1}, \dots, A_{i_r}$ are transformed into $e_1, \dots, e_r$ respectively, and the rest of the A_j for $j < k$ are transformed into linear combinations of the basis vectors appeared up to j .

Now, since

$$TA = \begin{pmatrix} | & & | \\ TA_1 & \cdots & TA_n \\ | & & | \end{pmatrix},$$

if A_k is a linear combination of previous columns, then

$$TA_k = \sum_{i=1}^{k-1} c_k^i TA_i,$$

but any TA_i for $i < k$ is either a standard basis vector in $\{e_1, \dots, e_r\}$ or a linear combination of these vectors. Hence, TA_k is also a linear combination of the standard basis vectors in $\{e_1, \dots, e_r\}$, that is, there exist scalars $a_k^j \in F$ for $j \in \{1, \dots, r\}$ such that

$$TA_k = \sum_{i=1}^{k-1} c_k^i TA_i = \sum_{j=1}^r a_k^j e_j = \begin{pmatrix} a_k^1 \\ \vdots \\ a_k^r \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

This means that if A_k is a **linear combination of previous columns**, then **all** components of TA_k after the r -th component are **zero**. On the other hand, if A_k is **not a linear combination of previous columns**, then there exists **at least one** component of TA_k after the r -th component that is **not zero**.

Now, we need to figure out how to use elementary row operations to transform TA_k into the next available standard basis vector if A_k is not a linear combination of previous columns.

1. Let's say that the next available standard basis vector is e_{r+1} . Since there exists at least one component of TA_k after the r -th component that is not zero, we can use row swapping, T_w , to swap the row with a nonzero component with the $(r+1)$ -th row.
2. Then we can use row scaling, T_c , to scale the $(r+1)$ -th row such that the $(r+1)$ -th component of TA_k becomes 1.
3. Finally, we can use row additions, $T_{a_1}, \dots, T_{a_q}$, to add appropriate multiples of the $(r+1)$ -th row to other rows to make all other components of TA_k zero.

We should show that these row operations will not change the form of the previous columns. Since TA_i are either standard basis vectors in $\{e_1, \dots, e_r\}$ or linear combinations of these vectors for $i < k$, **all** components of TA_i after the r -th component are **zero** for $i < k$. Hence,

1. T_w does not change the form of TA_i for $i < k$ since it only swaps rows after the r -th row.
2. T_c does not change the form of TA_i for $i < k$ since it only scales the $(r+1)$ -th row, which is zero for all TA_i for $i < k$.
3. $T_{a_1}, \dots, T_{a_q}$ do not change the form of TA_i for $i < k$ since they only add multiples of the $(r+1)$ -th row, which is zero for all TA_i for $i < k$.

Hence, we can apply $T_{a_q} \dots T_{a_1} T_c T_w$ to TA in order to transform A_k into the next available standard basis vector without changing the form of previous columns. Continuing this process for all columns of A , we can transform A into a matrix in **row reduced echelon form**, which represents the solution of the system of linear equations $Ax = b$.

Definition 3.4.7 (Gauss-Jordan Elimination):

The process of applying elementary row operations to transform a matrix into row reduced echelon form is called **Gauss-Jordan elimination**.

Let A be an m by n matrix and let b be a vector in F^m . We shall define the **algorithm** as follows:

- Starting from A_1 the first column of A and proceed column by column from left to right.
 1. For each column A_k , assuming that T_k have already transformed the previous columns of A into the appropriate form and the basis $e_1, \dots, e_r$ have been used in the previous columns, we will check whether A_k is a linear combination of previous columns by checking whether all components of $T_k A_k$ after the r -th component are zero.
 2. If it is, then do nothing and move on to the next column. If it is not, then apply elementary row operations to transform A_k into the next available standard basis vector e_{r+1} and move on to the next column.
- The elementary row operations to transform A_k into the next available standard basis vector are the follows:
 1. T_w that swaps the $r+1$ -th row with a row after the r -th row that has a nonzero component in TA_k .
 2. T_c that scales the $r+1$ -th row such that the $r+1$ -th component of TA_k becomes 1.
 3. $T_{a_1}, \dots, T_{a_q}$ that add appropriate multiples of the $r+1$ -th row to other rows to make all other components of TA_k zero.

Then, for A_{k+1} , $T_{k+1} = T_{a_q} \dots T_{a_1} T_c T_w T_k$.

Theorem 3.4.8 (Non-Square Matrix I):

Let A be an m by n matrix and $Ax = b$ be a valid system of linear equations. If $m < n$, then the system of linear equations $Ax = b$ has either **no solution** or **infinitely many solutions** (suppose that the field F has infinitely many scalars).

Proof 3.4.8:

Let $C = \text{RREF}(A)$ be the row reduced echelon form of A and let d be the vector such that $Cx = d$ represents the solution of the system of linear equations $Ax = b$. Since $m < n$, there are more columns than rows in C , hence there is at least one column in C that is not a standard basis vector.

If the system of linear equations have a solution, then that column must be associated with a **free variable**. That is, there is at least one variable that can vary freely without affecting the validity of the solution. Hence there must be infinitely many solutions of the system of linear equations $Ax = b$ since there are infinitely many scalars in F that can be assigned to the free variable.

■

Corollary 3.4.9 (Non-Square Matrix II):

Let A be an m by n matrix, if $m < n$, then the columns of A are linearly dependent.

Proof 3.4.9:

Since the homogeneous system of linear equations $Ax = 0$ has always at least one solution, if $m < n$, then the homogeneous system of linear equations $Ax = 0$ must have infinitely many solutions by **Theorem 3.4.8**. Hence, the columns of A are linearly dependent.

■

Theorem 3.4.10 (Independent Columns of a Square Matrix):

Let A be an n by n matrix, if the columns of A are linearly independent, then A is invertible.

Proof 3.4.10:

Since the columns of A are linearly independent. From the way we defined the row reduced echelon form of a matrix, we can see that the row reduced echelon form of A must be the identity matrix I_n .

Hence, there is a sequence of elementary row operations that transforms A into I_n , let's represent the sequence of elementary row operations as $T = T_1 \cdots T_p$. Then, we have

$$TA = I_n.$$

Since T is invertible, then A must be the inverse of T , hence A is invertible.

■

5. General Vector Spaces

Theorem 3.5.1 (Set of Linearly Independent Vectors):

Let $V = F^m$ be a vector space and let $S = \{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ be a set of vectors in V . If $n > m$, then the vectors in S are linearly dependent.

Proof 3.5.1:

Consider the m by n matrix A whose columns are the vectors in S . Since $m < n$, by **Corollary 3.4.9**, the columns of A are linearly dependent. This shows that the vectors in S are linearly dependent. ■

Corollary 3.5.2 (Maximum Number of Linearly Independent Vectors):

Let $V = F^m$ be a vector space, then any set of more than m vectors in V are linearly dependent.

Corollary 3.5.3 (Number of Basis Vectors):

Let V be a vector space with a finite basis, then any basis of V has the same number of vectors.

Proof 3.5.3:

Let $\mathfrak{B}_e = \{e_1, \dots, e_n\}$ and $\mathfrak{B}_f = \{f_1, \dots, f_m\}$ be two bases of V , with $m < n$. Consider the following system of linear equations:

$$\sum_{i=1}^n v^i e_i = 0.$$

We can rewrite the system of linear equations as

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{j=1}^m v^i e_i^j f_j &= 0 \\ \sum_{j=1}^m \left(\sum_{i=1}^n v^i e_i^j \right) f_j &= 0, \end{aligned}$$

where $e_i = \sum_{j=1}^m e_i^j f_j$ for $i \in \{1, \dots, n\}$. Now, since $\mathfrak{B}_f$ is a basis of V , then the only solution of the system of linear equations is $\sum_{i=1}^n v^i e_i^j = 0$ for all $j \in \{1, \dots, m\}$. Since

$$\sum_{i=1}^n v^i e_i^j = v^1 e_1^j + v^2 e_2^j + \dots + v^n e_n^j = 0,$$

we can rewrite the system of linear equations as

$$Ev = \begin{pmatrix} e_1^1 & e_2^1 & \dots & e_n^1 \\ e_1^2 & e_2^2 & \dots & e_n^2 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ e_1^m & e_2^m & \dots & e_n^m \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} v^1 \\ v^2 \\ \vdots \\ v^n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

However, since $m < n$, and $Ev = 0$ has at least one solution $v = 0$, by **Theorem 3.4.8**, the system of linear equations $Ev = 0$ must have infinitely many solutions, which implies

$$\sum_{i=1}^n v^i e_i = 0$$

also has infinitely many solutions. Hence, $e_1, \dots, e_n$ are linearly dependent, which contradicts the fact that $\mathfrak{B}_e$ is a basis of V . Therefore, by contradiction, we have $m \geq n$. By a symmetric argument, we can also show that $n \geq m$. Hence, we have $m = n$. ■

Corollary 3.5.4 (Minimum Number of Vectors to Span a Vector Space):

Let $V = F^m$ be a vector space, then any set of less than m vectors in V cannot span V .

Definition 3.5.5 (Dimension of a Vector Space):

Let V be a vector space with a finite basis, then the number of vectors in any basis of V is called the **dimension** of V , denoted by $\dim(V)$.

Theorem 3.5.6 (General Vector Space to Cartesian):

Let V be a vector space with the field F and a finite basis $\mathfrak{B} = \{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$, then there is an isomorphism between V and F^n that maps v_i to the standard basis e_i for all $i \in \{1, \dots, n\}$.

Proof 3.5.6:

Let T be a function from V to F^n defined as follows:

$$T\left(\sum_{i=1}^n u^i v_i\right) = \sum_{i=1}^n u^i T(v_i) := \sum_{i=1}^n u^i e_i.$$

Since it is clear that T satisfies the properties of a linear transformation, we only need to show that T is bijective.

For any vector $u = \sum_{i=1}^n u^i v_i \in V$, it is mapped to $T(u) = \sum_{i=1}^n u^i e_i$. Hence $T(u) = T(w)$ if and only if $u = w$. Hence, T is injective.

Similarly, for any vector $u = \sum_{i=1}^n u^i e_i \in F^n$, it is mapped from $T\left(\sum_{i=1}^n u^i v_i\right) = \sum_{i=1}^n u^i e_i$. Hence, T is surjective.

Therefore, T is bijective, which shows that there is an isomorphism between V and F^n that maps v_i to the standard basis e_i for all $i \in \{1, \dots, n\}$. ■

Definition 3.5.7 (Ordered Basis):

Let V be a vector space with the field F and a finite basis $\mathfrak{B} = \{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$. The basis $\mathfrak{B}$ is called an **ordered basis** of V if the order of the vectors in $\mathfrak{B}$ is fixed. That is, $\mathfrak{B}$ is an **ordered list** of vectors in V .

Corollary 3.5.8 (Subspace Spanned by a Finite Set of Vectors):

Let V be a vector space with the field F and let $S = \{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ be a set of vectors in V . Then, the subspace spanned by S is isomorphic to F^m where m is the number of linearly independent vectors in S .

Proof 3.5.8:

Let $\mathfrak{B} = \{v_{i_1}, \dots, v_{i_m}\}$ be the set of linearly independent vectors in S . Since any vector in the subspace spanned by S can be written as a linear combination of the vectors in $\mathfrak{B}$, we have

$$\text{span}(S) = \text{span}(\mathfrak{B}).$$

Since $\mathfrak{B}$ is a set of linearly independent vectors, it is a basis of $\text{span}(\mathfrak{B})$. Hence, the dimension of $\text{span}(\mathfrak{B})$ is m and it is isomorphic to F^m . ■

Definition 3.5.9 (Coordinate):

Let V be a vector space with the field F and a finite ordered basis $\mathfrak{B} = \{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ and $I_{\mathfrak{B}} : V \mapsto F^n$ be the isomorphism defined in **Theorem 3.5.6**. Then, for any vector $v \in V$ defined as

$$v = \sum_{i=1}^n u^i v_i,$$

the **n-tuple**

$$v = \begin{pmatrix} u^1 \\ u^2 \\ \vdots \\ u^n \end{pmatrix} = I_{\mathfrak{B}}(v)$$

is called the **coordinate** of v with respect to the basis $\mathfrak{B}$.

Convention 3.5.10 (Coordinate Representation of a Vector):

In order to distinguish the coordinates of a vector $v \in V$ with respect to different bases, we will denote the coordinate of v with respect a particular basis $\mathfrak{B}$ as

$$\begin{pmatrix} u^1 \\ u^2 \\ \vdots \\ u^n \end{pmatrix}_{\mathfrak{B}}$$

or as $[v]_{\mathfrak{B}}$.

Theorem 3.5.11 (Matrix Form of Linear Transformations in General Vector Spaces):

Let V and W be two vector spaces with the field F and finite ordered bases $\mathfrak{B}_V = \{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ and $\mathfrak{B}_W = \{w_1, \dots, w_m\}$ respectively. Let T be a linear transformation from V to W . Then, there is an m by n matrix T such that for any vector $v \in V$, if $T(v) = w$, then we have

$$T[v]_{\mathfrak{B}_V} = [w]_{\mathfrak{B}_W}.$$

Proof 3.5.11:

From **Theorem 3.1.21**, we know that there is a unique linear transformation S from $F^n \mapsto F^m$ such that for any vector $v \in V$, if $T(v) = w$, then we have

$$S([v]_{\mathfrak{B}_V}) = [w]_{\mathfrak{B}_W}.$$

Now, let's consider the linear transformation

$$I_{\mathfrak{B}_W} \circ S : F^n \mapsto F^m.$$

As it maps from a Cartesian vector space to a Cartesian vector space, there is a unique m by n matrix T such that

$$T[v]_{\mathfrak{B}_V} = I_{\mathfrak{B}_W} \circ S([v]_{\mathfrak{B}_V}) = I_{\mathfrak{B}_W}(w) = [w]_{\mathfrak{B}_W}.$$

■

Definition 3.5.12 (Nullity and Rank of a Linear Transformation):

Let T be a linear transformation from a vector space V to a vector space W with dimensions. The **nullity** of T is the dimension of $\ker(T)$. The **rank** of T is the dimension of $\text{im}(T)$, denoted by $\text{Rank}(T)$.

Theorem 3.5.13 (How a Set of Independent Vectors Span a Vector Space):

Let V be a vector space with the field F with $\dim V = n$. If $S = \{s_1, \dots, s_n\}$ is a set of linearly independent vectors in V , then

$$\text{span}(S) = V.$$

Proof 3.5.13:

Since $S \subseteq V$, any linear combination of the vectors in S is also a linear combination of the vectors in V . Hence, we have $\text{span}(S) \subseteq V$.

Let $\mathfrak{B}$ be an ordered basis of V . Let S be the following matrix:

$$S = \begin{pmatrix} | & & | \\ [s_1]_{\mathfrak{B}} & \cdots & [s_n]_{\mathfrak{B}} \\ | & & | \end{pmatrix}$$

which defines a linear transformation from F^n to F^n . Since F^n and V are isomorphic, we will define a linear transformation S from V to V by S . Now, as isomorphisms preserve linear independence, $[s_1]_{\mathfrak{B}}, \dots, [s_n]_{\mathfrak{B}}$ are linearly independent in F^n . Hence, the matrix S is invertible, so does S .

Therefore, for any vector $v \in V$, if $u = S^{-1}(v)$, there is

$$I_{\mathfrak{B}} \circ S^{-1}(v) = S^{-1}[v]_{\mathfrak{B}} = [u]_{\mathfrak{B}} = \begin{pmatrix} u^1 \\ u^2 \\ \vdots \\ u^n \end{pmatrix}_{\mathfrak{B}}.$$

The claim is that the coordinates of u gives the coefficients of a linear combination of the vectors in S that equals to v . To show this, consider

$$I_{\mathfrak{B}}^{-1}(S[u]_{\mathfrak{B}}) = \sum_{i=1}^n u^i s_i.$$

However, we also have

$$I_{\mathfrak{B}}^{-1}(S[u]_{\mathfrak{B}}) = I_{\mathfrak{B}}^{-1}(SS^{-1}[v]_{\mathfrak{B}}) = I_{\mathfrak{B}}^{-1}([v]_{\mathfrak{B}}) = v.$$

Hence,

$$\sum_{i=1}^n u^i s_i = v.$$

Since this holds for any vector $v \in V$, we have $V \subseteq \text{span}(S)$. Therefore, we have $\text{span}(S) = V$. ■

Theorem 3.5.14 (Dimension of two Subspaces):

Let V be a vector space with the field F and let W_1 and W_2 be two subspaces of V . Then

$$\dim W_1 + \dim W_2 = \dim(W_1 + W_2) + \dim(W_1 \cap W_2).$$

Proof 3.5.14:

Consider the space $W_1 \cap W_2$. Let $\mathfrak{B}_{W_1 \cap W_2} = \{\alpha_i\}_{i \in I}$ be a basis of $W_1 \cap W_2$. Now,